



CROWN VETCH
Securigera varia
F: Fabaceae

This rapidly spreading perennial of S. Europe and W. Asia has thick leaves and deep roots, good for binding soil and controlling erosion.

2 m
6½ ft



BROOM
Cytisus scoparius
F: Fabaceae

Found in heaths across Europe, this shrub has strongly scented flowers and many slender, ridged, and angled branches traditionally used for brooms.



SCARLET RUNNER BEAN
Phaseolus coccineus
F: Fabaceae

Native to C. American mountains, the shoot of this perennial twists clockwise around its support. Its seeds (beans) are variously coloured.

3.7 m
12 ft



BLACK LOCUST
Robinia pseudoacacia
F: Fabaceae

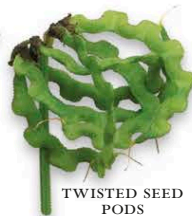
This vigorous deciduous tree, originally from S.E. USA, spreads by suckers. It has poisonous bark and leaves, and flat brown seed pods.

25 m/82 ft



PEA-LIKE
FLOWERS

30 cm
12 in



TWISTED SEED
PODS

HORSESHOE VETCH
Hippocrepis comosa
F: Fabaceae

This prostrate perennial, from S. Europe and the Mediterranean, is a major food plant for blue butterfly caterpillars. Its seed pods are twisted into horseshoe-like segments.

1 m
3¼ ft



COMPOUND
LEAVES

ROOT

BLUE-VIOLET
FLOWERS

LIQUORICE
Glycyrrhiza glabra
F: Fabaceae

This feathery perennial has smooth, small, oblong pods and deep roots. Extract from the roots is 50 times sweeter than sugar and is medicinal.

12 m
40 ft

COMMON LABURNUM
Laburnum anagyroides
F: Fabaceae

This deciduous tree is native to C. and S. Europe. Clusters of brown hairy pods (7.5 cm/3 in) contain toxic black seeds.



ALFALFA
Medicago sativa
F: Fabaceae

This deeply rooting perennial grows on chalk grassland throughout S.W. Asia, Europe, and the USA. It is a useful animal-feed crop and has medicinal properties.

80 cm
32 in



RED CLOVER
Trifolium pratense
F: Fabaceae

A food crop for grazing animals, this perennial has long-stalked basal leaves, and an oblong fruit pod hidden within its flowerhead.

1 m
3¼ ft

strong stem

narrow leaflet



1.5 m
5 ft

densely packed
flowers

GARDEN LUPINE
Lupinus polyphyllus
F: Fabaceae

Originating from western N. America and naturalized throughout Europe, this popular ornamental has hairy, black pods and undersides of leaves. Its flowers are fragrant.

NICEAN MILKWORT
Polygala nicaeensis
F: Polygalaceae

This perennial from France and Italy has flowers with two sepals and three joined petals, one of which is fringed, and a small capsule as a fruit.

40 cm
16 in

